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experience. This makes your device an ideal one, especially if you want to use it as an e-reader or a portable media player. Apart from the screen size and pixel count, you must also focus on the aspect ratio of the display for an enhanced multimedia experience. These days, tablet PCs offer two common aspect ratios—a standard 4:3 ratio and a widescreen 16:9 ratio.

Another factor that you should keep in mind is whether you will use the tablet mostly in the portrait or landscape mode. Most of the time, a tablet is used in the landscape mode. This mode increases the usable pixels, which enhances the experience of viewing a video or browsing a website. A tablet is generally operated in a portrait mode when it is used as an e-reader. So, before buying a tablet, think about the mode in which you are most likely to use the tablet in—landscape mode, portrait mode or a combination of the two. This will help in making an informed decision while investing in a tablet PC.

Processor. Like any other computing device, the processor of a tablet PC is its brain and the most important part of the device. Depending on the speed of the processor and the number of cores it has, one can determine the efficiency of a tablet PC. Most of the currently available tablets clock speeds between 1.0 and 1.6 GHz; however, most of the high-end tablet PCs are packed with dual-core processors that double the applications and number of processes the device can run.

RAM. The RAM is yet another factor that impacts the efficiency of the tablet. Higher RAM means better processing of information. Since tablets are mobile devices mostly used for multimedia purposes, surfing the Web, reading or playing games, their RAM requirements are not as much as a regular computer's. Most of the tablets sport 1GB RAM, while some high-end variants sport 2GB of RAM.

Touchscreen. Unlike a normal computer, the touchscreen capability

of the tablet PC is its most important feature, as the device does not work with mouse and keyboard. Most modern-day tablets sport capacitive touchscreens that offer multi-touch capabilities, ranging from two to four (and even ten) points of contacts. Ten points of contact at once allow you to use all ten fingers and utilise the on-screen keyboard well.

OS. Devices are all about the operating system (OS) these days—about Android, iOS and Windows. The war between operating systems has escalated to an entirely new level in the tablet market segment. And Canonical's recently showcased Ubuntu OS for tablets is all set to fuel this battle further. Apple's iOS that runs on iPad devices is the clear winner in the big-screen segment. But Android's offerings are not far behind. While Apple's devices can be an expensive affair in the long run because of the paid apps, Android has a lot to offer for free. Windows OS for tablets is yet to gain popularity and, hence, does not have as developed an ecosystem as the other two.

The final call

So before you finally bet your bucks on a big-screen tablet PC, here is a quick look at the strategy you should employ to choose the best for yourself.

Pick your OS first. Research the OSs available, and find out their advantages and disadvantages. Once you are sure about the OS you want to go with, your search for the right device will get easier.

Look at the connectivity options. Do you want a 'Wi-Fi only' model or a device that offers support for a dongle too?

Make a decision only after getting a hands-on feel. You can check out the options available by browsing the online sites first. But do not be lured by the deals available online till you get a hands-on feel for the device in a brick-and-mortar store. ●

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